

Haas School of Business — University of California, Berkeley

Negotiations and Conflict Resolution

MBA 252 — Fall 2026

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GSI: Oranda Hou

GSR: Irina Liu

Day: Wednesdays

Time: MBA252.1 — 8:00–11:00 AM | MBA252.2 — 2:00–5:00 PM

Location: C220

Dates: 8/26, 9/2, 9/9, 9/16, 9/23, 9/30, 10/7, 10/14, 10/21, 10/28

This is a living document, updated periodically based on your feedback

Course Description

Negotiation happens nearly every day. This course builds the knowledge and skills to negotiate better, in business and in life, across a wide range of situations including power, trust, and common cognitive biases.

The course has three aims: build your comfort and confidence negotiating; teach analytical frameworks (including game-theoretic approaches) for thinking strategically about both your own and your counterpart's behavior; and explore the psychology of negotiation — why people behave as they do, and how to manage emotions, yours and theirs.

Negotiation is both art and science, and this course treats it as both: you'll learn the theory of value creation and claiming, and you'll practice the skills — communication, preparation, self-awareness — through weekly negotiation exercises.

Course Expectations & Ground Rules

This is an experiential, demanding course. You will negotiate almost every week, and your engagement directly affects your peers' learning, not just your own. A few ground rules keep the exercises useful and the room safe to experiment in:

- Role instructions are confidential. Do not show or read them to other parties before or during a negotiation.
- Experiment with different tactics freely, but nothing involving physical intimidation or harassment.

Grading — 100 Points Total

Component	When	Points
Global participation (attendance, punctuality, engagement, quality of discussion)	Weekly	40
Preparation (worksheets submitted before class)	Weekly	20
Feedback (to negotiation partners)	Weekly	20
In-class quizzes	Sometime! 2-3	20
Press team assignment	Once in the first 5 weeks	(up to 3 bonus)

Participation (40 points)

Participation means showing up, on time and prepared, and contributing to discussion. Your attendance record and the quality of your comments are both assessed — see the Policies section below for how absences and lateness affect this score.

Preparation (20 points)

Submit the preparation worksheet for each negotiation exercise before class starts. Late preparation sheets are not accepted (see Late Assignment Policy); missing one costs 2 points.

Feedback (20 points)

- Give your negotiation partner at least one positive and one constructive comment immediately after each exercise.
- Email written feedback to your partner by Friday midnight each week, cc'ing the class email with “[Feedback Submission]” in the subject line.
- Worth ~2 points per week, including Week 10.

Pop quiz (20 points)

- Pop quiz in class to test your basic knowledge of fundamental negotiation concepts

Optional: Press team assignment (up to 3 bonus points)

- Make a video reel of the highlights of someone else's negotiation

Policies

Attendance & Absences

- **Notice requirement:** Always notify the professor by email as soon as you know you'll miss a class — ideally at least 24 hours in advance.
- **Point deductions (out of 100):**
 - Missed a class, gave at least 24 hours' notice: **–2 points**
 - Missed a class, did *not* give 24 hours' notice: **–3 points** (this replaces the 2-point deduction — it is not an additional penalty on top of it)

Free pass: Your first missed class each term costs nothing IF you send us an email ahead of time to let us know. No explanation required. Every absence after your first one in a term is scored using the deductions above.

Exceptions: If you're sick, have a family emergency, a religious observance, or jury duty, we'll take that into account. Specifically, for circumstances you couldn't reasonably have predicted 24 hours out, like sudden illness or injury, a family emergency, or bereavement, we understand that you could not give advance warning. You should still notify us as soon as you're able, even if that's after the fact. A brief email is enough to invoke this, formal documentation is only needed if the absence extends beyond a single class.

Punctuality

- Missing more than 30 minutes of a class (arriving late or leaving early): –1 point.
- Missing more than 30 minutes of a class, *without advance notice*: –2 points.

Global participation score (engagement)

- We are grading your participation and engagement in class. Some people speak less than others, and that's OK. But if you're checked out or clearly not paying attention, we notice that and take that as part of the global participation score.
- If you are coming in and out of the class regularly, we generally notice that as well.

Class-Switching

You're expected to attend your registered section.

Electronic Devices

No laptops, phones, or other devices during lecture, except when an exercise explicitly calls for one. Bring your laptop regardless, since some exercises need it. Tablets in airplane mode need the professor's approval at the start of class. You will lose your electronic device privileges if it happens that you're not using your tablet to take notes.

Late Assignments

–1 point per day late. Assignments are due at the start of class; exceptions must be discussed before the due date. Preparation worksheets are never accepted late, please confirm your bCourses upload went through.

Cheating & AI Use

Cheating includes: reading another party's confidential role information before an exercise's debrief; consulting current/former students or the internet about an exercise or assignment; and plagiarism. Any of these minimally results in 0 points on the assignment and a report to the Office of Student Conduct. AI writing tools (e.g. ChatGPT) may be used only as specifically instructed in class. Using them outside those guidelines violates the Berkeley Haas Code of Conduct.

Research Use of Class Data

Negotiation outcomes are confidential. With your permission, anonymized data may be used to refine future exercises or for research on negotiation patterns. Participation is voluntary, has no effect on your grade, and you may request deletion of your data at any time.

Weekly Schedule

Week	Date	Topic & Case	Readings	Due
1	8/26	Fundamentals: <i>Yerba Mate</i>	Thompson Ch. 1, 3	Nothing! Come as you are
2	9/2	Integrative Negotiation I: <i>New Bike</i>	Thompson Ch. 2, 4	New Bike prep sheet
3	9/9	Salary Negotiations: <i>Salary Negotiation</i>	Thompson p.370-378; job-offer readings (bCourses)	-Salary prep sheet -Feedback to New Bike partner
4	9/116	Integrative Negotiation II: <i>The Grand Strand</i>	Getting Past No p.31-104; bCourses readings	-Grand Strand prep sheet -Feedback to Salary partner
5	9/23	Power in Negotiations: <i>Myti-Pet Food</i>	Thompson p.102-124, 240-250; Getting Past No p.105-158	-Myti-Pet prep sheet -Feedback to Grand Strand
6	9/30	Real negotiation analysis, group processes, how to say no	—	-Prep for Challenger discussion -Feedback to Myti Pet
7	10/7	Negotiation IRL (guest speaker) + special fun activity	—	
8	10/14	Hostage negotiators!! Trust: <i>Bullard Houses</i>	Thompson Ch. 6, p.351-360; deception readings (bCourses)	-Bullard Houses prep sheet
9	10/21	Shadow negotiations, social influence & coalitions: <i>Fastskin</i>	Ch. 7, 12; persuasion readings (bCourses)	-Fastskin prep sheet -Feedback to Bullard House
10	10/28	Cross-functional team negotiation: <i>Best Stuff on Earth</i>	Cross-Functional Team Negotiations (bCourses)	-Best Stuff on Earth prep sheet -Feedback to Fastskin

Full reading citations and links are on bCourses. Shadow-negotiate window for Week 8: 10/10–10/17.

Appendix A — Assignment Details

Press team assignment (10 points)

During a simulation, students can opt to film other students negotiate and produce a short “highlight reel” to be presented to the class. This assignment will require you to observe a negotiation and carefully analyze the video recordings in order to identify the pivotal moments and key strategies.

Appendix B — Reference Material

Recommended Reading

- Thompson, L. (2007). *The Mind and Heart of the Negotiator*, 5th ed. Prentice Hall.
- Neale, M. & Lys, T. (2015). *Getting (More Of) What You Want*. Basic Books.
- Ury, W. (1991). *Getting Past No*. Penguin.
- Voss, C. & Raz, T. (2016). *Never Split the Difference*. Random House.
- Malhotra, D. & Bazerman, M. (2008). *Negotiation Genius*. Bantam.

Study.net Access

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